Part I

A Tranquilizing Philosophy

The people of Tlön are taught that the act of counting modifies the amount counted, turning indefinites into definites. The fact that several persons counting the same quantity come to the same result is for the psychologists of Tlön an example of the association of ideas or of memorization.

—Jorge Luis Borges, “Tlön, Uqbar, Orbus Tertius”

This epistemology-soaked orgy ought to come to an end.

—Albert Einstein, letter to Erwin Schrödinger, 1935